



University of
St Andrews

Letter to School

Invitation for your School to participate in a research study titled: **User-Centred Design of Games for Gaelic Digital Normalisation**

Dear Mrs Laura MacIver,

I am a student in the School of Computer Science at the University of St Andrews, working under the supervision of Dr Abd Alsattar Ardati.

I am writing to you to ask if you would be willing to allow me to undertake a research study in your School, with your pupils as our research participants, following our previous discussion.

About the Study

The study aims to explore how digital games can be developed and used to support active Gaelic usage within Gaelic Medium Education (GME) contexts. I am investigating how game-based interaction can contribute to making Gaelic a more natural part of learners' everyday digital experiences. Further information about the research is included below:

- Your school has been selected because you have an established GME programme with pupils aged 8–12 years, and I believe the research will be of value to your pupils, your school, and the wider GME community.
- If your school participates, a research session will be conducted during regular school hours at your premises. The session will last approximately 45–60 minutes per participant group and will involve:
- Game-Playing Activities (30–40 minutes): Pupils will interact with an age-appropriate game prototype designed for Gaelic language engagement. All activities will be engaging and designed to fit naturally into GME contexts.
- Post-Game Evaluation: Pupils and teachers will complete a brief, informal questionnaire about their experience.
- Discussion Group (10–15 minutes): Pupils will discuss their experience using child-friendly language. No formal assessment or testing of Gaelic language ability will occur.
- As a token of appreciation, each participating pupil will receive a small stationery item and a printed certificate of participation

If you are interested in your School taking part, further details are available in the Participant Information Sheets I have attached to this letter (both the Parent/Guardian version and the Teaching Staff version).

If your School is to take part, to ensure I minimise the time burden on your school, here is what I am asking of you and your staff:

Before the Study (estimated time: 1–2.5 hours total)

- **Initial recruitment and game verification meeting:** A brief meeting (15–30 minutes) to confirm school participation and identify suitable participant classes.
- **Mock Game Session with Teacher(s):** Before the main research session, I will conduct a brief demonstration session with the classroom teacher(s) (30 mins) who will supervise the research. This will allow the teacher to:
 - Review the game prototype and research activities
 - Confirm age-appropriateness and cultural suitability
 - Verify alignment with school safeguarding
 - Provide feedback before the main session
- **Distribute information and consent materials:** I will provide all printed materials. School administrative staff or a designated teacher will distribute the Parent/Guardian Participant Information Sheets and consent forms to the identified class(es), and collect completed consent forms. I estimate that this will take 15–20 minutes plus collection time over one week.
- **Identify suitable pupils:** The class teacher will identify pupils meeting our selection criteria (aged 8–12, GME programme enrolled, familiar with technology). This requires approximately 15–30 minutes of teacher time.

During the Study: (estimated time: up to 2 hours on research day)

- **Provide a quiet, suitable space:** I require one classroom or available learning space where the research session can take place without significant disruption. The space should have basic facilities (tables, chairs, access to power for laptops).
- **Teacher presence during sessions:** A familiar classroom teacher should be present throughout the entire research session to provide support for pupils and to assist with safeguarding and duty-of-care responsibilities. The session will last approximately 45–60 minutes.
- **No additional preparation required:** I will manage all technical setup, session delivery, and data collection.

After the Study: No further involvement is required. Data collection and analysis will be conducted by myself.

Total estimated time commitment from school staff: approximately 2–3 hours spread over a two-week period.

I am committed to working around your school's timetable and will schedule the research session at a time that minimises disruption to your pupils' learning.

Before the project commences, I need to know whether you would be willing, in principle, for your school to be involved. This will allow me to obtain approval for this research study from the University of St Andrews' Teaching and Research Ethics Committee and the Local Education Authority.

If you are interested in your School participating in the research study and/or you want any further information about the study, please get in contact with us using the details below.

Many thanks,
Luke Macleod

Contact details

Researcher: Luke Macleod

Email: lcm31@st-andrews.ac.uk

Supervisor: Dr Abd Alsattar Ardati

Email: abd.ardati@st-andrews.ac.uk

Phone: +44 (0)1334 46 1861